Prepositions of place and location

Goal: By the end of this lesson, you will be able to say where a landmark is located using prepositions of place (in, on, at, next to, between, opposite, in front of, behind) and to locate a city on a map (in the north of, on the coast).

The idea in two lines: A preposition of place links a thing to the place where it is. **In** is for a country, a city or an enclosed space; **on** for a surface, a river or a coast; **at** for a precise point or an address.

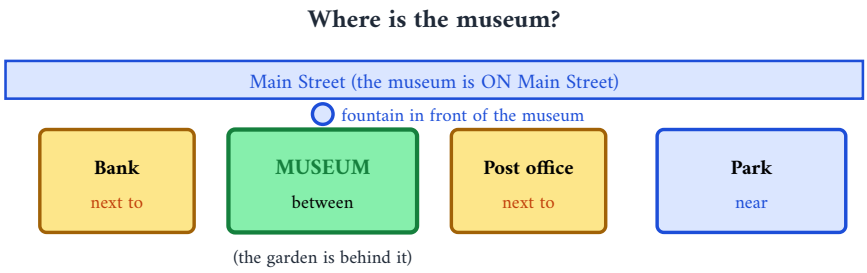


Figure 1: A street plan showing the main prepositions of place around the museum.

🔵 Rules and concepts

1. **In**: countries, cities and enclosed spaces. *Timgad is in Algeria. The mosaics are in the museum.*
2. **On**: surfaces, streets, rivers and coasts. *The mosque is on Didouche Mourad Street. Cairo is on the Nile.*
3. **At**: a precise point or an address. *Meet me at the entrance. The library is at 12 Liberty Street.*
4. **Position words:** *next to, between … and …, opposite, in front of, behind, near, far from, above, under.*
5. **On a map:** *in the east of* a country (inside it), but *to the east of* another place (outside it). *Constantine is in the east of Algeria. Tunisia is to the east of Algeria.*
6. **Locating a landmark:** *be located / situated + preposition. The Great Pyramid is located near Cairo.* Question: **Where is it located?**

🟢 Examples

1. Complete: *The Martyrs' Memorial is … Algiers, … a hill.* **Answer:** in Algiers, on a hill. **Explanation:** *in* for a city, *on* for a surface (a hill, a coast).
2. Complete: *The bookshop is … the bank … the pharmacy.* **Answer:** between the bank and the pharmacy. **Explanation:** *between* needs two places joined by *and*.
3. Locate on the map: *Tamanrasset / Algeria / south*. **Answer:** Tamanrasset is in the south of Algeria. **Explanation:** the town is inside the country, so *in*, not *to*.

🟠 Common BEM mistakes

- Translating word for word: "*on* Algeria", "*in* the coast". Correct: *in Algeria, on the coast*.
- Writing "in front" without *of* or "next" without *to*: *in front of the school, next to the bank*.
- Using *between* with only one place: "between the bank". Add *and + second place*.
- Confusing *in the north of* (inside) and *to the north of* (outside the place).

🟡 Quick review

- in: country, city, room, box; on: street, coast, river, surface; at: point, address.
- next to / beside, opposite, in front of, behind, between … and …, near.
- in the north of (inside) ≠ to the north of (outside).
- X is located / situated + preposition + place.
- Question: Where is it? Where is it located?

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